

Data Retention Policy

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Purpose and Scope

Check It Out is committed to managing data responsibly and in compliance with all applicable laws. This Data Retention Policy outlines how we classify, retain, and delete data collected through our influencer marketing platform. A well-defined retention policy is essential for legal compliance, risk reduction, and efficient data management.

This policy applies to all data we handle – including data about our influencers, brand clients, and internal staff – and covers personal information, business records, financial data, and any other sensitive information under our control. It is designed to meet the requirements of the EU's General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) and other relevant laws, and to follow industry best practices.

Scope

This policy covers all forms of data (electronic or physical) that Check It Out collects, processes, or stores, including:

- Personal data of influencers and brand representatives
- Business and campaign data provided by brands
- Financial information related to payments and transactions
- Metadata from social media integrations
- Usage data and analytics
- Internal company records
- Security and audit logs
- Enhanced security data including session binding, IP geolocation, and fraud prevention analytics

Everyone at Check It Out (employees, contractors, and partners) is required to adhere to this policy. We also expect our third-party service providers to manage and dispose of data in a manner consistent with this policy and our contractual requirements.

Data Classification and Legal Basis

To apply appropriate retention practices, Check It Out classifies data into categories based on sensitivity, regulatory requirements, and business needs. Each category is mapped to its GDPR Article 6 legal basis:

Personal Data (Personally Identifiable Information – PII)

Definition: Any information relating to an identified or identifiable individual, including names, usernames, contact information, profile photos, social media handles, and biographical/demographic information. **GDPR Legal Basis:** Article 6(1)(b) - Performance of contract (platform services) and Article 6(1)(f) - Legitimate interests (fraud prevention, security) **Classification:** Confidential **Access:** Authorized personnel only for disclosed purposes

Business & Campaign Data

Definition: Campaign briefs, matchmaking history, content deliverables, performance metrics, collaboration records, success stories, and case study materials. **GDPR Legal Basis:** Article 6(1)(b) - Performance of contract

and Article 6(1)(f) - Legitimate interests (service improvement, analytics, marketing) **Classification:** Internal/Sensitive **Access:** Operations and analytics teams with need-to-know

Financial and Payment Data

Definition: Transaction IDs, payment amounts, payout receipts, billing information, tax documentation (excluding payment card details stored by Stripe). **GDPR Legal Basis:** Article 6(1)(c) - Legal obligation (tax compliance, financial reporting) **Classification:** Regulated Confidential **Access:** Finance/admin personnel only

Social Media Metadata

Definition

Public profile information, engagement metrics, follower counts, audience demographics obtained via third-party APIs. **GDPR Legal Basis:** Article 6(1)(b) - Performance of contract (matching services) and Article 6(1)(f) - Legitimate interests (analytics) **Classification:** Confidential **Access:** Authorized personnel following API terms

Usage Data and Logs

Definition: IP addresses, device identifiers, browser data, website analytics, cookies, security logs, access logs. **GDPR Legal Basis:** Article 6(1)(f) - Legitimate interests (security, service improvement) with user consent for non-essential cookies **Classification:** Technical/Operational **Access:** IT and security teams

Employee and Internal Data

Definition: HR records, payroll information, internal communications, access logs, performance reviews. **GDPR Legal Basis:** Article 6(1)(b) - Employment contract and Article 6(1)(c) - Legal obligation (employment law compliance) **Classification:** Confidential Internal **Access:** HR and management as required

Enhanced Security Data

Definition: Session binding information, IP geolocation data processed through MaxMind GeoLite2 databases, impossible travel detection analytics, bot protection scores from reCAPTCHA Enterprise, security event logs, and fraud prevention metadata. **GDPR Legal Basis:** Article 6(1)(f) - Legitimate interests (fraud prevention, session security, bot protection) **Classification:** Technical/Security Confidential **Access:** Security and IT teams with need-to-know basis

Legitimate Interest Assessment

We conduct regular assessments for all legitimate interest processing to ensure our security processing provides compelling benefits (account protection, platform integrity) that do not override user privacy rights. Data minimization, anonymization, and automated deletion measures are implemented to reduce privacy impact.

Master Data Retention Schedule

This schedule provides unified retention periods referenced across all our policies:

Data Category	Retention Period	Legal Basis	Deletion Trigger	Automated Process
User Account Data	Active period + 6 months	Contract performance	Account deletion request	Yes

Data Category	Retention Period	Legal Basis	Deletion Trigger	Automated Process
Campaign Content & Records	3 years post-campaign	Contract performance	Campaign completion + 3 years	Yes
Financial/Transaction Data	5 years	Legal obligation (tax)	5 years from transaction	Yes
Analytics Data (Google Analytics)	14 months	Legitimate interest (with consent)	Automatic deletion	Yes
Cookie Consent Records	3 years	Legal obligation (proof of consent)	3 years from consent	Yes
Security Logs	12 months	Legitimate interest (security)	12 months from creation	Yes
Marketing Communications	Until unsubscribe + 30 days	Consent	Unsubscribe request	Yes
Inactive Account Cleanup	24 months inactivity	Data minimization	Account marked inactive	Yes
Case Study & Marketing Data	5 years or until opt-out	Legitimate interest	User opt-out request	Manual
Social Media API Tokens	Until disconnection + 7 days	Contract performance	API disconnection	Yes
Employee Records	Employment + 5 years	Legal obligation	Departure + 5 years	Manual
Session Security Data	7 days (session lifetime)	Legitimate interest (security)	Session expiration	Yes
Security Audit Logs	30 days	Legitimate interest (security)	Automated deletion	Yes
IP Geolocation Cache	7 days maximum	Legitimate interest (security)	Session expiration	Yes
reCAPTCHA Scores	Real-time processing only	Legitimate interest (security)	Not stored	N/A

Enhanced Security Data Retention Details

Session Security Data Management

Session Binding Information

- **Content:** IP address correlation with active sessions (anonymized)
- **Purpose:** Session hijacking prevention
- **Retention:** Exactly 7 days (matches session cookie lifetime)
- **Storage:** Encrypted Redis cache system within EU
- **Deletion:** Automatic upon session expiration or 7-day limit

IP Geolocation Processing

- **Source:** MaxMind GeoLite2 databases (downloaded, no external requests)
- **Granularity:** Country and city level only
- **Retention:** Maximum 7 days in correlation cache

- **Processing Location:** Exclusively within EU infrastructure
- **Privacy Protection:** No precise coordinates or detailed location data stored

Fraud Prevention and Bot Protection

Security Audit Logs

- **Content:** Masked IP addresses, geographic regions, risk scores, authentication events
- **Retention:** 30 days encrypted storage
- **Location:** Google Cloud Storage bucket in Warsaw (europe-west1)
- **Deletion:** Automated deletion after 30 days
- **Access:** Encrypted at rest, security team access only

Real-Time Security Processing

- **reCAPTCHA Scores:** Processed in real-time, not stored in our systems
- **Impossible Travel:** Calculated dynamically, results not persistent
- **Risk Assessment:** Used for immediate security decisions, no long-term storage

Security Incident Documentation

- **Scope:** Detailed security events requiring investigation
- **Retention:** 12 months for analysis and compliance
- **Review:** Quarterly assessment for continued necessity
- **Disposal:** Manual secure deletion after 12 months unless legal hold

Influencer & Client Personal Data

Active Account Retention

- Contact details (email, phone): Retained while account active + 6 months post-deletion
- Profile information and photos: Retained while account active + 30 days post-deletion
- Social media handles: Retained while account active + 12 months (for duplicate prevention)
- Biographical data: Retained while account active + 30 days post-deletion
- Campaign history and performance: 3 years post-campaign completion

Adult-Only Platform Verification

- Age verification records: 3 years (legal protection against minor access claims)
- Account closure due to age issues: Immediate deletion + 30-day grace period for appeals

Inactive Account Process

- Accounts inactive for **18 months:** Automated notification sent
- Accounts inactive for **21 months:** Second notification with deletion warning
- Accounts inactive for **24 months:** Final notice with 30-day response period
- Accounts inactive for **25 months:** Account marked for deletion, 30-day grace period
- Accounts inactive for **26 months:** Automatic irreversible deletion

Post-Deletion Retention

- Consent records: 3 years (legal defense)

- Dispute-related communications: 5 years or until resolution
- Invoice names for tax purposes: 5 years (legal obligation)
- All other personal data: Deleted within 30 days of account deletion

Brand & Campaign Data

Campaign Records:

- Active campaign data: Retained during campaign + 3 years
- Campaign performance metrics: 3 years post-campaign completion
- Brand-influencer match history: 5 years (fraud prevention, conflict avoidance)
- Content deliverables and reports: 2 years post-campaign completion
- Case study and marketing materials: 5 years or until user opt-out

Archival Process

- After 3 years: Personal identifiers removed, business statistics retained
- After 5 years: Complete deletion unless legal hold applies

Individual Deletion Requests

- Acknowledgment: 48 hours maximum
- Evaluation: 15 days of receipt
- Match history anonymized if no compelling legal basis for retention
- Response provided within 30 days per GDPR requirements

Financial and Transaction Data

Retention Period: 5 years from transaction date (following Polish Accounting Act requirements)

Specific Categories

- Transaction metadata: 5 years
- Invoice records: 5 years
- Tax documentation: 5 years
- Payout receipts: 5 years
- Billing contact information: 5 years
- VAT exemption records: 5 years (Check It Out is not VAT registered)

Post-Period Disposal

Secure deletion after 5 years unless extended by legal hold

Processor Coordination

Stripe and payment processors subject to independent legal obligations with coordinated deletion requests where legally permissible

Social Media Metadata

Active Connection Retention:

- Follower counts and engagement metrics: 12 months rolling (monthly refresh)
- API tokens: Refreshed per platform requirements, deleted immediately upon disconnection + 7 days

- Profile insights (when authorized): While connection active + 30 days

Data Refresh Schedule

- Instagram/Facebook metrics: Updated monthly, previous data deleted after 12 months
- TikTok metrics: Updated bi-weekly, previous data deleted after 6 months
- YouTube metrics: Updated monthly, previous data deleted after 12 months

Disconnection Process

All tokens and fetched data deleted within 7 days of account disconnection

Usage Data & Analytics

Raw Log Retention:

- Server logs with IP addresses: 12 months
- Database access logs: 24 months (security monitoring)
- Application error logs: 6 months
- Cookie data: Per cookie policy (typically 30-90 days for functional, 14 months for analytics)

Analytics Data

- Google Analytics: 14 months auto-deletion configured
- Aggregated platform statistics: Indefinite retention (anonymized)
- User-identifiable analytics: 14 months maximum

Security-Related Logs

May be retained up to 24 months for incident investigation

Employee & Internal Data

Employment Records:

- HR files during employment: Throughout tenure + 5 years post-departure
- Payroll records: 5 years post-departure (Polish tax obligations)
- Performance reviews: Throughout tenure + 2 years post-departure
- Contract and pension information: As required by local employment law (typically 10+ years)

Applicant Data

- Hired candidates: Converted to employee records
- Non-hired candidates: 12 months post-application
- Interview notes and assessments: 12 months post-decision

Internal Communications

- Routine emails: 24 months unless business-critical
- Board meeting minutes: Indefinite retention (corporate records)
- Operational documents: 3 years unless ongoing relevance

Account Access

Terminated immediately upon departure with secure data archival

Enhanced Backup Data Retention

Backup Schedule Integration:

- Personal Data backups: Aligned with primary data retention periods
- Financial Data backups: 5 years + backup cycles
- Operational Data backups: 30 days maximum for technical backups
- Campaign Data backups: 3 years + backup cycles

Backup Deletion Process

- Automated purging aligned with primary data deletion
- Manual verification required for legal hold scenarios
- Restoration followed by immediate re-deletion of expired data

Technical Implementation

- Daily incremental backups: 30 days retention
- Weekly full backups: 90 days retention
- Monthly archive backups: Aligned with data category requirements
- Quarterly disaster recovery backups: 12 months maximum

Enhanced Third-Party Processor Management

Mandatory Processor Requirements:

Google Cloud Platform/OVH

- Data Processing Addendum: Annual renewal required
- Deletion timeline: 90 days maximum post-contract termination
- Audit rights: Quarterly compliance verification
- Data residency: EU-only storage confirmed in writing

Stripe (Payment Processing)

- Deletion coordination: 30-day response requirement for deletion requests
- Legal retention conflicts: Documented exception process
- Audit requirements: Semi-annual compliance verification
- Data minimization: Only necessary transaction data shared

Google Analytics

- User-level data deletion: 14 months automatic + manual deletion capability
- IP anonymization: Mandatory configuration confirmed
- Data transfer: EU-US Data Privacy Framework + Standard Contractual Clauses
- Opt-out compliance: Browser-level and plugin-based deletion

Social Media APIs (Meta, etc.)

- Token deletion: Immediate upon user disconnection + 7 days
- Data refresh compliance: Per platform-specific requirements

- Unauthorized sharing prevention: Contractual prohibitions documented
- API violation monitoring: Monthly compliance checks

Security Service Coordination

MaxMind GeoLite2

- **Processing Model:** Downloaded database files, no data transmission to MaxMind
- **Data Residency:** Exclusively EU-based processing
- **Update Schedule:** Monthly database refresh from MaxMind
- **License Compliance:** Commercial license documentation retained 3 years post-termination
- **No DPA Required:** No personal data shared with MaxMind services

reCAPTCHA Enterprise (Google LLC)

- **Data Processing Agreement:** Google Cloud Terms with security addendum
- **Transfer Mechanism:** EU-US Data Privacy Framework + Standard Contractual Clauses
- **Data Residency:** US processing with EU safeguards
- **Retention Alignment:** Real-time processing only, no storage conflicts
- **Deletion Coordination:** Not applicable (no data storage)

Processor Audit Schedule

- Quarterly: Data inventory verification
- Semi-annually: Deletion compliance audit
- Annually: Contract and security review
- Ad-hoc: Breach or violation investigation

Automated Security Data Lifecycle

Daily Processing

- Session security correlation: Continuous monitoring with 7-day rolling deletion
- Real-time threat assessment: Immediate processing, no persistent storage
- Cache management: Automated cleanup of expired geographic data

Weekly Maintenance

- Security log analysis: Automated compliance verification
- Database updates: MaxMind GeoLite2 refresh process
- System integrity checks: Automated retention policy compliance verification

Monthly Reviews

- Security data audit: Verification of automated deletion processes
- Processor compliance: Google reCAPTCHA service status verification
- Legal basis assessment: Review of legitimate interest justifications

Cross-Border Transfer Documentation

Transfer Mechanism Records

- EU-US Data Privacy Framework certifications: Verified quarterly
- Standard Contractual Clauses signed with processors: Retained for 5 years post-termination
- Transfer Impact Assessments: Updated annually, retained for 3 years
- Supplementary measure implementation evidence: 3 years

Processor Verification

- US service provider compliance documentation: Annual collection and verification
- Government access request logs from providers: Retained 5 years
- Technical safeguards testing records: 2 years

Transfer Consent Records

- Explicit consent for essential transfers: 3 years from consent
- Notification records about transfer mechanism changes: 3 years
- Data subject information request responses: 2 years

reCAPTCHA Enterprise Transfer Documentation

- **Transfer basis records:** EU-US Data Privacy Framework certification verification (quarterly)
- **Standard Contractual Clauses:** Executed agreements retained 5 years post-service termination
- **Supplementary measures:** Technical safeguard documentation (encryption, access controls)
- **Transfer impact assessments:** Annual reviews retained 3 years

No International Transfer Categories

- **MaxMind Processing:** EU-exclusive data processing documentation
- **Session Security:** Local processing verification records
- **Security Logs:** Geographic location confirmation (Warsaw, EU)

All transfer documentation is maintained securely and made available to supervisory authorities upon legitimate request.

User Rights and Security Data

Enhanced Deletion Procedures for Security Data:

Standard Data Subject Requests

- **Session Security Data:** Immediate anonymization upon request
- **Cached Geographic Data:** Deletion within 48 hours
- **Security Logs:** Personal identifiers masked within 15 days
- **Incident Records:** Evaluation for ongoing security needs vs. deletion rights

Right to Object to Security Processing

- **Assessment Period:** 15 days to evaluate compelling legitimate grounds
- **Security Override:** May continue processing if essential for account protection
- **Alternative Measures:** Implementation of alternative security where technically feasible
- **Documentation:** Detailed justification provided for security processing continuation

Impact on Platform Functionality

- **Session Security Opt-Out:** May result in forced shorter session timeouts (1 hour vs. 7 days)
- **Geographic Processing Objection:** May affect impossible travel protection
- **Bot Protection Objection:** May require manual verification for all account actions
- **Full Security Opt-Out:** May result in account restrictions or termination if security cannot be maintained

Data Subject Rights Implementation

Right to Erasure (Article 17 GDPR):

- Request acknowledgment: 48 hours maximum
- Identity verification: Secure multi-factor process
- Impact assessment: Service disruption warnings provided
- Deletion timeline: 15 days for standard requests, 30 days for complex cases

Technical Deletion Standards

- Database deletion: Cryptographic erasure where possible
- Backup purging: Automated verification of deletion propagation
- Log sanitization: Personal identifier removal from operational logs
- Third-party coordination: Verified deletion confirmations required

Special Protections for Adult-Only Platform

- Age verification: Enhanced verification for borderline cases
- Immediate deletion: Any minor data deleted within 24 hours of discovery
- Legal protection: 3-year retention of age verification records for compliance

Deletion Verification

- User confirmation: Detailed deletion report provided
- Audit trail: Comprehensive logging without personal data
- Backup verification: Quarterly backup content audits
- System testing: Annual deletion process verification

Legal and Regulatory Compliance

GDPR Compliance Framework

- Storage limitation: All retention periods justified by purpose and legal basis
- Data subject rights: Enhanced deletion, access, and portability procedures
- Accountability principle: Comprehensive documentation and audit trails
- Privacy by design: Automated deletion and minimal retention defaults

Record of Processing Activities (ROPA)

- Data category mapping: Retention periods documented for each processing activity
- Legal basis tracking: Regular review and updates
- Third-party processing: Comprehensive processor inventory and oversight
- Audit preparation: Readily accessible compliance documentation

Cross-Border Transfer Safeguards

- EU-US Data Privacy Framework: Primary basis for US transfers
- Standard Contractual Clauses: Implemented for all non-adequacy transfers
- Transfer impact assessments: Documented for high-risk jurisdictions
- Supplementary measures: Additional encryption and access controls
- Regular review: Annual assessment of transfer adequacy

Legitimate Interest Assessment Documentation

Security Processing Justification Records

- **Purpose assessment:** Annual documentation of security measure necessity
- **Balancing test:** User privacy impact vs. security benefit analysis
- **Data minimization:** Technical measure documentation and effectiveness review
- **Alternative analysis:** Evaluation of less privacy-intrusive security options

Retention: LIA documentation retained 3 years for regulatory compliance **Review Schedule:** Annual assessment with updates for material changes **User Access:** Summaries available upon request (detailed methodology protected as trade secret)

Audit and Accountability

Enhanced Monitoring

- Quarterly retention audits: Automated compliance verification
- Deletion process testing: Semi-annual verification procedures
- Third-party audits: Annual processor compliance verification
- Incident tracking: Comprehensive retention failure documentation

Documentation Requirements

- Processing records: Real-time ROPA maintenance
- Deletion logs: Detailed audit trails without personal data retention
- Legal basis reviews: Annual verification and updates
- Policy exceptions: Management approval and periodic review

Training and Oversight

- Staff training: Quarterly data protection updates
- Responsibility assignment: Clear data steward roles
- Escalation procedures: Defined compliance issue resolution
- Performance monitoring: Regular policy adherence verification

Policy Review and Updates

Review Schedule

- Quarterly: Regulatory change assessment
- Semi-annually: Retention period effectiveness review

- Annually: Comprehensive policy audit and update
- Ad-hoc: Legal requirement changes or significant business changes

Update Process

- Legal team review: All changes require legal counsel approval
- Stakeholder consultation: IT, security, and operations input required
- User notification: 30-day advance notice for material changes
- Version control: Comprehensive change documentation and archival

Continuous Improvement

- Industry best practice monitoring: Quarterly benchmarking
- Regulatory development tracking: Monthly legal update reviews
- Technology advancement integration: Semi-annual capability assessment
- User feedback incorporation: Ongoing improvement process

Contact Information

For questions about this Data Retention Policy or to request data deletion, access, or correction, contact:

Email

checkitout.inbox@gmail.com **Subject Lines:**

- Data deletion requests: "Data Protection Request - Deletion"
- Access requests: "Data Protection Request - Access"
- Correction requests: "Data Protection Request - Rectification"
- General retention questions: "Data Retention - [Your Question]"
- Content reports: "Content Report - [Issue]"

Response Time

48 hours acknowledgment, resolution per GDPR timelines (15 days standard, 30 days complex)

Our team will verify your identity and assist with your request in accordance with applicable data protection laws and this policy.

This Data Retention Policy is part of our comprehensive legal framework including our Privacy Policy, Terms & Conditions, and Cookie Policy.